



Grimdark Covenant MINIATURES

THE CARNIVAL OF SAINTS

The Carnival of Saints

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Through the 40 days of Lent, the solemn Saints of Byzantium rise from their holy mausoleums to fight the great war once again. Their utmost mission bringing joy to the land.

Each year their most fanatic devotees take arms and join the Carnival of Saints, the colourful and bizarre skirmish parties that escort each of the chosen. They use unconventional tactics and weaponry, having Joy as their highest virtue. Even hell fears their playful tunes, as they herald the presence of an Annihilator Saint.

The first recorded Carnival happened when the headless corpse of St. Theodore Strelates rose up from its tomb in Euchaneia, taking the head of the statue that presided over his burial site. He was seen marching with a giant crucifix, sharpened into a sword, tirelessly trudging on for

days on end, and gathering a growing throng of followers that recognized him as Saint Theodore. Their destination was the recently opened Hellgate in Jerusalem, though the retinue of the Saint had no idea of this, and were scarcely armed, carrying just their instruments, their clothes, and some provisions. Driven to the march by the loud sounds of the songs and the chants, a Heretic cult, ambushed the Saint and his devotees when they were nearing Nazareth, slaughtering all of the Revelers and stopping Saint Theodore by smothering him with a giant pile of the bodies of both Heretic and Faithful alike.

In the years following the first Carnival, other Warrior Saints awoke and led similar processions to wage war on the infidels, each more ready to battle than the last.



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The Carnival of Saints

The great war grinds belief into something unrecognizable. But some people don't break. They unravel. And what they find on the other side of madness, they call divine.

Warband Creation

You have 700 🍷 to recruit a Carnival of Saints Warband for a campaign (> see Starting a Warband). The Carnival is Faithful.

Special Rules

The following special rules apply to a Carnival of Saints Warband (including any Variants).

- **Our Saint We Follow:** The warband must include an Annihilator Saint as its leader, and will immediately fail Morale, becoming Shaken for the next round, if the Annihilator Saint is taken out of action.

Some Carnival of Saints units and weapons have the **BLISS** and **FRENZY** Keywords:

- ✦ **BLISS:** Whenever a friendly model with the Keyword **BLISS** rolls a Critical Success for any Action, place a **BLESSING MARKER** next to it. Battlekit with the Keyword **BLISS** only applies this bonus for the Actions directly related to that piece of Battlekit.
- ✦ **FRENZY:** Allows the model to make a Charge from 18" away (instead of 12"). On a result of 6 for the charge, place a **BLESSING MARKER** next to the charging model.

Armoury Tables

Carnival of Saints Warbands can have the following Battlekit. Battlekit with a bullet point [•] is unique to Carnival of Saints Warbands and its rules can be found in the Carnival of Saints Battlekit section after the Armoury. (• see Battlekit in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook).

Ranged Weapons

Automatic Pistol	Limit: 1	20 🍷
Automatic Rifle	ELITE only, Limit: 1	40 🍷
• Bang Gun Revolver	Limit: 2	13 🍷
Blunderbuss	Shield Combo	5 🍷
• Fireworks Launcher	Consumable, Limit: 1	20 🍷
Flamethrower	Limit: 2	30 🍷
Heavy Shotgun	Shield Combo, Limit: 2	20 🍷
Machinegun		50 🍷
Musket	Bayonet Lug	5 🍷
Shotgun	Bayonet Lug, Shield Combo	10 🍷
Sniper Rifle		3 ☼



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Melee Weapons

• Crucifixion Glaive	ELITE only, Limit: 1	50 🕯
• Violin and Bow	Limit: 2	15 🕯
Bayonet	Shield Combo	2 🕯
Flail/ Scourge		5 🕯
Great Hammer/ Maul		10 🕯
Great Sword/ Axe		12 🕯
Polearm		7 🕯
Knife		1 🕯
• Rapier		12 🕯
Sword/Axe		4 🕯
Trench Club		3 🕯
• Saint's Coffin	Limit:1, Reveler Fanatic Only	25 🕯

Grenades

Frag Grenades		7 🕯
Molotov Cocktail		5 🕯
Incendiary Grenades		15 🕯

Shields

Holy Icon Shield	ELITE only, Shield Combo	2 ☼
Trench Shield	Shield Combo	10 🕯

Armour

Reinforced Armour	ELITE only	40 🕯
Standard Armour		15 🕯

Equipment

• Cherubim Servant	Consumable, Limit: 3	7 🕯
Combat Helmet	Headgear	5 🕯
Gas Mask		5 🕯
Mountaineer Kit	Limit: 2	3 🕯
Martyrdom Pills	Consumable, ELITE only, Limit: 2	1 ☼
• Prophetic Music Sheet	Limit: 3	7 🕯
• Seraphic Dulcimer	Limit: 1	2 ☼
Shovel		5 🕯
• Throwing Knives	Jester Knight and Troupe Master Only	5 🕯

Only in the coming of Easter does the Carnival exist. Through the forty days of Lent, the Saints of old Byzantium rise from their mausoleums and start their march towards the gates of hell.

And wherever a Saint marches, the Carnival follows.



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The Carnival of Saints Battlekit:

The following Battlekit items are unique to the Carnival of Saints Warband. Rules for all other items are in the standard Battlekit section (► see Battlekit in the Trench Crusade Digital Rulebook). See the Carnival of Saints Special Rules section for any weapons that have the **BLISS** Keyword.

Crucifixion Glaive | 50 ☹ | ELITE only, Limit: 1

Type	Range	Keywords
2-Handed	Melee	+2 INJURY MODIFIER, BLISS, FIRE, HEAVY, CUMBERSOME

- ✦ **Sundering Reach:** You can make an additional Melee Attack against every other enemy model up to 1" away from the initial target.
- ✦ **Burning Passion of Christ:** After making the Injury Roll for a Crucifixion Glaive, if the target has the **DEMONIC** or **HERETIC** Keyword, place 1 extra **BLOOD MARKER** next to the target model (even if the Injury Roll has No Effect).

Violin and Bow | 15 ☹ | Limit: 2

Watching one of the possessed fighting is a strange spectacle. They thirst for their enemies to be a part of their melody, an ensemble of flesh, steel and screaming.

Type	Range	Keywords
2-Handed	Melee	+1 DICE

- ✦ **Melody of Flesh and Steel:** On a Minor Hit result, place an additional **BLOOD MARKER** next to the target model. On a failed Attack Roll, or a No Effect injury result, place a **BLESSING MARKER** next to the model wielding the Violin and Bow.

Fireworks Launcher | 20 ☹ | Limit: 1

This terrifying artifact is both the perfect start to a revel and the perfect end to a heretic's life.

Type	Range	Keywords
2-Handed	36"	-1 INJURY DICE, BLAST 4", BLISS, CONSUMABLE, FIRE, RELOAD, SCATTER

Bang Gun Revolver | 13 ☹ | Limit: 2

Jester Knights love to have the first laugh.

Type	Range	Keywords
1-Handed	12"/Melee	ARMOUR PIERCING, ASSAULT, PISTOL

- ✦ **Killing Joke:** Add +1 **INJURY DICE** to rolls for Ranged Attack made with this weapon if the target has not yet been Activated this Turn.

Rapier | 12 ☹

Most times, a precise strike through an enemy's opening is all it takes.

Type	Range	Keywords
1-handed	Melee	-1 DICE, +1 INJURY DICE

- ✦ **Bullseye:** This weapon has the **IGNORE ARMOUR** Keyword on a 10+ Success Roll.



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Saint's Coffin | 25 🗡️ | Reveler Fanatics ONLY, Limit: 1

Heavy, old and laden with the signs of a thousand battles, this creaking wooden casket is the resting place of the Annihilating Saint when they are dormant, and the hiding place of many a Reveler when they are awake.

Type	Range	Keywords
Weapon	Melee	+1 INJURY MODIFIER, LEADER, CUMBERSOME

- ✦ **Herculean Task:** The sheer size and weight of the coffin leaves its carrier restrained, reducing its movement characteristic to 4"/Infantry and halving their charge bonus.
- ✦ **Impenetrable Casket:** The Saint's Coffin counts as a piece of terrain for determining Line of Sight for Ranged Attacks. (*You can use a separate model and place it in front of the Reveler*)
- ✦ **Heavenly Gains:** A model that is Promoted in a campaign while carrying the Saint's Coffin gains the **STRONG** keyword. Following custom, the Saint's Coffin will then be passed to its next carrier, becoming equipped to a different model from then on.

Cherubim Servant | 7 🗡️ | Limit: 3

These little creatures follow the Matron around, and gleefully give their lives for the servants of the Saint.

Type	Range	Keywords
Equipment	-	CONSUMABLE

- ✦ **Cherubim Servant:** Up to 3 models can be equipped with a Cherubim Servant each.
- ✦ **Guardian Angel:** Whenever an attack made against the equipped model is a Success or Critical Success, you can say that their Cherubim Servant will sacrifice their life to defend them from the blow. If you do so, add a **-2 INJURY MODIFIER** to Injury Rolls for attacks made against the equipped model for the remainder of the current Activation (to a maximum of -3 total). After the end of the Activation, the effect ends, and the Cherubim is consumed, becoming unable to be used again in the future.

Prophetic Music Sheet | 7 🗡️ | Limit: 3

These sheets seem full of gibberish and written using nonsensical notation, but the minds that composed its melodies were briefly touched by the divine.

Type	Range	Keywords
Equipment	-	-

- ✦ **Prophetic Inspiration:** Carrying these divine music sheets gives the ability to attempt a charge targeting an enemy model out of Line of Sight, rolling 1 extra **D6** (and using the highest result) to determine the Charge bonus.



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Seraphic Dulcimer | 2☼ | Limit: 1

Those who hear the music that emanates from this sacred instrument feel their chest almost bursting at each passing moment, as the melody promises an inkling of the music of the Angels with every bar.

Type	Range	Keywords
Equipment	-	MUSICAL INSTRUMENT, HELD

- ✦ **Heavenly Fanfare:** This Battlekit is a Musical Instrument with the **Fanfare** ability. In addition, when equipped on a Possessed Celebrant their **Fanfare** ability instead adds +2 **DICE** to Risky Success Rolls for friendly models that are taking a Dash **ACTION** within 4" of the Possessed Celebrant, as these blessed players are able to channel The Song.
- ✦ **Song of the Sweetest Frenzy:** Friendly models within 4" of a model with the Seraphic Dulcimer roll 1 extra **D6** (and use the highest result) to determine their Charge bonus.

Throwing Knives | 5☼ | Jester Knights and Troupe Master Only

Hidden in unseen places in their armour, these little daggers are dangerous tools in the hands of a Jester Knight, and most foes see but a flash of light before they feel their sting.

Type	Range	Keywords
Equipment	-	-

- ✦ **Quick Silver:** Whenever a model equipped with Throwing Knives is the target of an enemy model's Charge, they get to interrupt the opponent's Activation to make a Ranged Attack Action with the **IGNORE COVER** and **IGNORE LONG RANGE** keywords against the charging model. On a Success, don't make an Injury Roll, instead place a **BLOOD MARKER** next to the charging enemy model. On a Critical Success, place two **BLOOD MARKERS** instead. The opponent's Activation continues as normal after this effect.

Elite Warband Entries:

— Servants of God —

1 Annihilator Saint - Cost 150 ☹

A Carnival of Saints Warband must include 1 Annihilator Saint.

Even hell fears the playful tunes of the Carnival, as they herald the presence of an Annihilator Saint, holy warriors who have exceeded the limitations of humanity, becoming unending weapons of the Church.

Through the 40 days of Lent, the solemn Saints of Byzantium rise from their holy mausoleums to fight the great war once again and bring an end to the enemies of God.

Amongst the faithful, they are the deadliest vanguard warriors in the eastern front, wielding weapons burning with the passion of Christ, firearms sanctified by the supreme pontifex and old powerful relics.

Movement	Ranged	Melee	Armour	Base
6"/Infantry	+2 DICE	+3 DICE	0	50mm

Battlekit ✚ An Annihilator Saint can have any Battlekit from the Carnival of Saints Armoury Tables.

Abilities ✚ **Inspired Rapture:** The blissful attitude of the Carnival inspires the Saint's pious slaughter. Whenever another friendly model in a Carnival of Saints Warband within 18" of the Annihilator Saint gains a **BLESSING MARKER**, place an additional **BLESSING MARKER** next to the Annihilator Saint. This effect doesn't include **BLESSING MARKERS** granted at the start of the game by the **BLESSED** Keyword.

✚ **Gift of Massacre:** Whenever the Annihilator Saint makes an Injury Roll for one of their attacks, it can consume its own **BLESSING MARKERS** as if they were **BLOOD MARKERS** from the target enemy model (to add +1 **INJURY DICE** to the Injury roll, or count towards a Bloodbath). In addition, they can always make a Bloodbath in melee for a cost of 3 **BLOOD MARKERS**.

✚ **Resurrected Warrior:** Add -1 **INJURY DICE** to Injury Rolls for an Annihilator Saint. Due to their undying resilience, the Saint has an additional Battle Scar, but cannot consume Martyrdom Pills.

Keywords CARNIVAL, ELITE, FEAR, FRENZY, LEADER, STRONG, TOUGH







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0-1 Cherub Matron – Cost: 105 ☹

Cherub Matrons are scattered across the different Mausoleums where the Saints of Old Byzantium rest, each guarding the holy resting place of an Annihilator Saint. Wherever the Saint goes, they follow, bringing along their Cherubim servants. These caring figures lead the ranks of the Carnival, making sure every new Reveler is equipped for their holy mission and their patron is free to focus on carnage.

Movement	Ranged	Melee	Armour	Base
6"/Infantry	+1 DICE	+0 DICE	-2	32mm

Battlekit A Cherub Matron only has one hand available. She cannot equip 2-handed ranged weapons or a suit of Armour. No restrictions apply to other Battlekit.

Abilities

- ✦ **Nourishing Presence:** At the start of its Activation, you can place a BLOOD MARKER next to the Cherub Matron in order to create a Cherubim Servant, and send it to protect another friendly model within 6" (as long as it's not already equipped with one). If the Servant created by the Nourishing Presence ability has not been used by the end of the game, it will be lost forever.
- ✦ **The Virtue of Sacrifice:** Whenever a Cherubim Servant is consumed, place a BLESSING MARKER next to the Cherub Matron.

Keywords CARNIVAL, ELITE, SKIRMISHER



Cherub Matron Illustration (Work in Progress)



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Tales of the Carnival Matrons

The arrival of the Carnival is said to awaken a fervour unlike any other. Entire towns abandon their homes to join the holy procession. Farmers leave their fields, labourers their workshops, and fathers their families. By dawn, roads are choked with newly made Revelers marching toward the front, eager to offer themselves to the Great War.

Yet wherever the Carnival goes through, another tale follows.

The elder women speak in hushed tones of the Cherub Matron, a woman of a distinct silhouette that echoes wide hips, some will say "child bearing hips" as she is draped in mourning silks and hidden beneath an impossibly vast skirt. She moves through the settlements that welcome the Carnival, distributing medicines and offering comfort to those scarred by the ravages of war, often greeted as a blessing sent by God Himself.

According to these stories, the Cherub Matron poses as an ordinary midwife. She moves among the camps and villages in the wake of the procession, offering aid to expectant mothers when the strange births begin:

Every child still within the womb is born the night the Carnival arrives.

It matters not whether the mother was due in days, months, or weeks. The births come all the same.

Physicians denounce this tale as superstition, yet it persists among the widows.

It is said no child is born crying during the passing of the carnival.

Instead, laughter fills the newborn's lungs the moment they meet the cold air of night.

And so, it is spoken as a reminder of the approaching Lent, that the Matron follows a particular distinction: Should the child be a daughter, she will be left untouched.

Should the child be a son, he will be for the Carnival.

By morning, all the town's sons are gone.

It is a sacred necessity. All men are destined to fight the Great War, even those who have only just drawn breath. The sons taken by the Matron are offered to the Annihilator Saint, their brief lives transformed into an act of faith. What becomes of the boys afterward is a matter of debate. Priests will insist that their souls are elevated directly into Heaven. The townsfolk tell a different story.

Frontline reports state that movement has been observed beneath the Matron's skirts. Tiny hands and rabid faces. The flutter of wings. And when the slaughter reaches its peak, golden infantile creatures covered in blood emerge from the darkness beneath her robes and scatter across the battlefield.

The Matron denies these accusations. When questioned, she simply smiles.

"Every child needs a mother" she says.



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0-2 Jester Knight – Cost: 65 ⚔

“The world is a sad joke... Why not look the part?”

Those who endure will be rewarded. After the 40 relentless days of Lent, laughter and song become dead silence. The pathetic fanatics who joined and survived the Carnival will be forever changed by the steady hand of war.

Their festive and joyful dance now turned cunning and calculated, coordinated agility replacing the impulsiveness of insanity. It is believed among the faithful that these fools were touched by the divine, as if their survival was some sort of twisted miracle.

These few are worthy. They will be brought to Nuova Venezia and be knighted, receiving land, heraldry, and a suit of armour. In time, they will become members of the Holy Order of Divine Comedy, and join the ranks of the Jester Knights.

Although wearing colourful painted armours with vibrant golden filigree, the Jester Knights are fierce, elite shock units. They are masters in the art of death, wielding a wide range of weapons both in close and long range. Their morale is unwavering. They will obliterate the enemies of YHWH.

Movement	Ranged	Melee	Armour	Base
6"/Infantry	+1 DICE	+1 DICE	0	32mm

Battlekit A Jester Knight can have any Battlekit from the Carnival of Saints Armoury Tables. Jester Knights must be equipped with a suit of Armour. No restrictions apply to any other Types of Battlekit.

Abilities ✦ **Harlequin's Luck:** Once per Activation a Jester Knight can reroll 1 single dice for any Success Roll.

Keywords CARNIVAL, BLISS, ELITE, FRENZY, IGNORE FEAR





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Troop Warband Entries:

—The Joyful—

Reveler Fanatics — Cost: 30 ☹

When a Saint rises again to massacre the enemies of the Christendom, believers of all walks of life abandon their lives for 40 days, donning colourful clothes and arming themselves with whatever they can find. They follow the lines of acolytes, hearing some distant song that only they can listen to.

These fools have taken the custom of wearing bizarre masks, believing these charms will ward them from evil and help them face the horrors of hell. It is rumoured that they usually hang bells from their body and choose to carry musical instruments as weapons, forming a cacophony of metal as they make their frenzied charges through the enemy lines.

It is because of the raucous nature of the Carnival that their ranks appear much larger to the adversaries of the Warrior Saints, and the joy that the Revelers bring whenever they go makes the dogs of Hell go blind with rage and hatred, for it tugs at their blackened hearts.

Movement	Ranged	Melee	Armour	Base
6"/Infantry	-1 DICE	+0 DICE	0	32mm

Battlekit A Reveler Fanatic can buy any Battlekit from the Carnival of Saints Armoury Tables. Reveler Fanatics can't equip a suit of Armour.

Abilities ✦ **Former Militias:** Up to 2 Reveler Fanatics can have a +0 Ranged Profile in exchange for the FRENZY Keyword.

Keywords CARNIVAL, BLISS, FRENZY





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0-3 Possessed Celebrant – Cost: 55 ⚔

It is believed artistic souls are specially drawn to the Carnival. They rarely survive more than a few days, but they bring the Carnival to its fullest potential. Rumours suggest they hear the maddening songs of the Angels, and they need - or rather, they must attempt to play them.

Even though the exhaustion and the mental toll that the Great War exacts on the human soul is great, Celebrants cannot stop. They are like matches about to go out, compelled to rhythmically twist their body as they sing and play without pause or regard for rest. These fellows are revered in the Carnival, with Revelers dressing them up with the relics of their fallen comrades, turning them into walking, singing symbols of their faith.

Movement	Ranged	Melee	Armour	Base
8"/Infantry	-1 DICE	+0 DICE	0	25mm

Battlekit The Possessed can buy any Battlekit from the Carnival of Saints Armoury Tables.

Abilities

- ✦ **Fanfare:** Add +1 DICE to Risky Success Rolls for friendly models that are taking a Dash ACTION and are within 4" of one or more Possessed Celebrants or Musical Instruments.
- ✦ **Violent Crescendo:** For each successful Risky Success Roll, Possessed Celebrants gain +1 DICE to every following Success Roll until the end of their Activation. On a roll that is a Failure, the Possessed Celebrant is overwhelmed by the Song of the Angels and is Downed.
- ✦ **Grand Finale:** As they take their final breath the bodies of the Possessed are able to make incredible feats. When a Possessed Celebrant is taken Out of Action, they get to interrupt the opponents Activation to make a Melee or Ranged Attack Action against the enemy model that took them out of action. The opponents Activation follows as normal after this effect.

Keywords CARNIVAL, BLISS, RISKY



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0-1 Zancudo Stilt-Walkers – Cost: 45 Ⓜ

“If God watches from above, holiness must be measured in height.”

Within the carnival, there's an undeniable appetite for risk and self-destruction. This appetite often leads to creativity. Since the beginning of the Great War, the faithful have spent their lives seeking ascension. Few have embraced this calling in such literal terms as the Zancudos of the Carnival of Saints.

What began with a quest to reach the skies soon became a sacred mutilation ritual. Stilt-Walkers have their lower legs removed and replaced with ornate iron extensions, covered by ridiculously long pieces of fabric of the most scandalous colors. Every step filled with agony and the frantic desire to worship. They believe these contraptions allow them to reach the grace of God and hear the Song more clearly amidst the chaos of warfare. With the blessing of height, they have become the Carnival sharpshooters.

Some already possessed the deadly finesse to weave dances with flaming chains, spitting fire like true pyromancers. Others prefer fighting at long range, wielding rifles to great effect.

Through the Stilt-Walkers, the Jester Knights recognized a brutal military asset within these undisciplined warbands. Enemy soldiers cannot ignore the giant silhouettes drifting through the fog. Many waste precious ammunition firing at these blatant targets, blissfully unaware that distracting the audience is always part of the performance.

Movement	Ranged	Melee	Armour	Base
6"/Infantry	+0 DICE	-1 DICE	0	32mm

Battlekit A Stilt Walker can buy any Battlekit from the Carnival of Saints Armoury Tables. Stilt Walkers are always equipped with Molotov Cocktails, and can never lose them (this is represented in their profile).

Abilities

- ✦ **Carnival Stilts:** Add 3" to the height of a Stilt-Walker when determining if it receives the Elevated Position modifier for any Ranged Attacks that it makes.
- ✦ **Difficult Manoeuvres:** Due to their extra height, place an additional Blood Marker next to a Stilt-Walker when they suffer a Down result on the Injury Table. Also, Stilt Walkers can't make a Charge **ACTION**, and their Dash distance is halved.
- ✦ **Explosive Trickery ACTION:** A Stilt-Walker can take an Explosive Trickery **ACTION**. If they do so, take a Risky Success Roll for the model and add +2 **DICE** to the roll. If the Roll is a Failure, place 1 **Blood Marker** next to the Stilt Walker and end their Activation. If the roll is a Success or Critical Success, roll a **D3**. For the rest of the Activation the Stilt-Walker can make up to **D3** ranged attacks when using their Molotov Cocktails to make a Shoot **ACTION**, adding an extra 4" to their range.

Keywords CARNIVAL, BLISS



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Art and Rules by
Miguel G. Cebrián
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0-1 Joy Wagon – Cost: 150 ☹

An Illuminated Celebrant leads the Wagon, chosen between the rest because their prowess or their faith inspires the others in the Carnival. They attempt to channel the songs of the angels through a massive musical instrument, and beckon others to join them in their frenzied charges through enemy lines, to help their poor, wretched souls hear the voice of the Angels one last time before they are finally sent to Hell, where they will rot for eternity. A failed communicant has been assigned to pull it, a joyless, almost mindless creature that will not stop their advances until their last drop of blood is wrought from their body.

Movement	Ranged	Melee	Armour	Base
8" / Infantry	-	+2 DICE	-2	60mm

Battlekit A Joy Wagon always has an Instrument of Submission. This Weapon is part of the Joy Wagon and cannot be removed or lost throughout the campaign for any reason. They cannot have any other Battlekit.

- Abilities**
- ✦ **Heavy Vehicle:** The Joy Wagon is carried through the battlefield by a failed Communicant. Even though they are strong enough to pull it, it is impossible for them to make a Climb or Jump Action. When a Joy Wagon suffers a Down result in the Injury Table, place an extra **BLOOD MARKER** next to it and treat the result as a Minor hit instead.
 - ✦ **Songs of the Angels ACTION:** A Joy Wagon can take a Song of the Angels Action. If they do so, take a Risky Success Roll for the model and add **+1 DICE** to the roll for each friendly Possessed Celebrant within 1" of the Joy Wagon. If the roll is a Success or Critical Success, the player on top of the Wagon channels the divine song for a couple of seconds - every enemy model within 6" of the Wagon must make a Success Roll as if they were falling, losing consciousness for a second after hearing the Song. If the roll is a Failure the model is taken Down (but no **BLOOD MARKERS** are put besides that model), and a Falling Injury Roll must then be taken for that model. Models with the **ARTIFICIAL** Keyword aren't affected.
 - ✦ **Sunder the Fallen:** A Joy Wagon can move through enemy models as long as they are Down without provoking an attack of opportunity. When charging a model that is Down, the Joy Wagon can opt to go through it and use the rest of its move value to continue its path in the same direction. Whenever the Joy Wagon goes through any model that is Down using this ability, make a Melee Attack against that model. (You can hit the same model up to two times in the same Activation through a Move and a Dash Action.) The Wagon can't pass through a model and attack it with this ability and make a **FIGHT** Action with it as the target in the same Activation.

Keywords CARNIVAL, BLISS, BLESSED 1, FEAR, FRENZY, GOLEM

Instrument of Submission

Type	Range	Keywords
2-Handed	Melee	+1 INJURY DICE if the target is Down

- ✦ **Trampled to Death:** This weapon treats Down Injury results as Out of Action results for enemy models on a 25mm base.



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Art and Rules by
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0-1 Troupe Master – Cost: 70 ☹

There are not many Revelers that make it alive through Lent, and their plight makes them into dangerous soldiers that abandon the frivolous attitude of their past, embracing their new life in the Order of the Divine Comedy.

But not all are ready to give up the fanfare, and they refuse their ordaining Some go completely mad and tear up their masks so everyone can see their unhinged visage, free to continue reveling. Others feel that they are ordained by God to keep the Carnival alive through the whole year, and still there are some that simply enjoy the festivities so deeply that they can't leave their lesser brothers in revel to fend for themselves, becoming sort of “masters of ceremonies”.

Whichever they are, they have one thing in common, and that is prowess and passion without equal, which they gladly use to bring swift and joyful end to the enemies of the Carnival.

Movement	Ranged	Melee	Armour	Base
6”/Infantry	+0 DICE	+2 DICE	0	25mm

Battlekit A Troupe Master can buy any Battlekit from the Carnival of Saints Armoury Tables, except for suits of Armour or the Prophetic Music Sheet.

Abilities

- ✝ **Unhinged Visage:** Enemy fighters without the **FEAR** or **NEGATE FEAR** Keywords must make a Success Roll before making a Charge against a Troupe Master. If the roll is a Success or Critical Success, the model can continue with the Charge normally. If the roll is a Failure, the enemy model must move directly away from this model a minimum of 3” instead.
- ✝ **Lead the Fanfare:** A Troupe Master can take a Lead the Fanfare **ACTION**. Take a Success Roll. If the roll is a Failure, nothing happens. If the roll is a Success or Critical Success, friendly Reveler Fanatics within 4” of this model may move up to 2” in any direction, but may not Retreat or Charge using this movement.

Keywords CARNIVAL, BLISS, FEAR, FRENZY

The Carnival of Saints Glory Items:

Head of St. Benedict of Nursia | 9 ✨ | ELITE Only, Limit: 1

One of the holiest relics in all of the Church, the hand that carries it will be followed and protected by all manner of miracles, much like the late St. Benedict was for most of his life.

Type	Range	Keywords
Equipment	-	HELD, BLESSED 2

- ✦ **St. Benedict's Blessing:** A model holding the Head of St. Benedict of Nursia has a +1 Success Roll Modifier for each BLESSING MARKER they have. For Attack Roll results above 12, add a +1 INJURY MODIFIER to the Injury Roll for each increment beyond 12.

Holy Vestige Rifle | 6 ✨ | ELITE only, Limit: 1

Powered by the incorrupt heart of a martyred Saint, these blessed and extremely rare weapons fire rounds of pure holy fire, capable of piercing the very souls of those who oppose YHWH's children.

Type	Range	Keywords
2-Handed	24"	AUTOMATIC (2), ARMOUR PIERCING, FIRE

- ✦ **Burning Passion of Christ:** After making the Injury Roll for a Holy Vestige Rifle, if the target has the DEMONIC or the HERETIC Keyword, place 1 extra BLOOD MARKER next to the target model (even if the Injury Roll has No Effect).

Rhapsodic Attire | 3 ✨ | Jester Knights only

Reserved for the highest ranks within the Order, these suits of armour enhance the already great dexterity of Jester Knights, and allow them to bring greater glory to their Patron.

Type	Range	Keywords
Armour	-	-1 INJURY MODIFIER, BLESSED 1

- ✦ **Limitless:** A model wearing the Rhapsodic Attire gains +2 inches to their Movement Characteristic. In addition, if they have spent their free Move ACTION, they can use their Dash ACTION to make a Retreat or a Charge if they haven't used that option yet in the same Activation.



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Warband Variants:

Coming soon! Need more work and a lot of testing.

The Holy Order of the Divine Comedy

An elite Jester Knight focused Variant with new Elite models.

Nuova Venezia is a mystery, a legendary base of the faithful only known to the Knights of the Order. It is rumored the bastion is hidden deep within the corrupted territories of Italy, where heresy rules. And yet, it remains untouched, growing stronger each year. Here the Reveler survivors are turned into the nimble Jester Knights, becoming incredible performers and masters of the arts; as well as perfected soldiers for the cause. The Great Comedians lead their squads, supported by their second in command, the Tragedy, carrying tactical missions through the Eastern Front.

The Trinity of Solace

A Variant with 3 Saints and new Troops with positioning shenanigans.

Some Saints have been misshaped by war, becoming stoic warriors that reject the joys of the Carnival. The eccentric Sisterhood of Solace follows these Saints, serving them in absolute silence, never allowing the Saints to even feel their presence or setting eyes on them. While the Carnival of Saints carries loud melodies that frighten the heretics, the Trinity comes without notice, and leaves no survivors to tell the story... Not even the holy sisters.

The Procession of Earthly Delights

A Medieval and Renaissance Art inspired Variant focusing on Revelers, Celebrants and little weirdos.

In the first days of a Procession, all sorts of fun-loving and strange people gather. Some are stranger than others, and some may not be people at all. Such are the so-called Demon Revelers, although they usually are just minor imps and devils, looking to escape the oppressive atmosphere of Hell and just frolic for a while. This might seem strange, given the Procession's usual goals of battling Heretics and approaching the mouth of Hell, but demons don't really like each other very much.

If you enjoyed the project, consider following us on Kickstarter/MyMiniFactory!

We'll be launching the Carnival of Saints on the 23d of June (2026):

<https://www.kickstarter.com/projects/grimdarkcovenant/carnival-of-saints/>



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What's Grimdark Covenant?

We are a brand-new creative studio based in Spain founded by Miguel G. Cebrián, a Concept Artist and Illustrator coming from the videogame industry. We aim to create awesome minis and illustrations with a rich grimdark narrative. We reject AI, and will never use it. Everything we create is 100% human-made.

Credits

I'm forever grateful to my partner Andrea, who has been an essential support and eventually become a big part of the project, writing some of our coolest lore, as well as managing our social media.

I would like to thank the incredible people making Trench Crusade. Especially Mike Franchina, who's been my idol since I started in this industry, and Tuomas Pirinen for making my favorite games to date.

Couldn't have made this without my wargaming group in Madrid, who made me fall in love with the game and helped me playtest the warband:

- Fer (True2myself_) who contributed massively to the rules, lore, and playtesting.
- Sergio and Nares from Trench Crusade España, who are the heart of the community here.
- Josito, Luis and Pepe from Battletricks, the coolest wargaming youtube channel from Spain.
- Mario, Silvestre, Valtan and Jorge, who helped a lot with the rules and lore.

Big thanks to our friends at Steamhead Studio and Hungry Troll, especially Manu and Juan, who've been my mentors within the tabletop industry and our partners for our first Kickstarter. And to Jorge Amor (@yokai.miniature.art) who did an incredible job painting our minis and gave us amazing advice.

And yes, we made minis for this project! Created in partnership with the excellent Maximiliano Espinelli (@maxiyagamii), who's been a big part of the creator community since the start of Trench Crusade. Maxi also contributed a lot of the magic that make the rules and units design awesome.

And finally, my friends Vicent and Alba, who have been helping make this Kickstarter a real thing, contributing to our development with cool opportunities, and helping polish our design and production.



The Carnival of Saints painted by Jorge Amor (@yokai.miniature.art)